



NextLaBIS

Wireframe exploration

Mid-fi grayscale wireframes mapping the design space for the NextLaBIS ELN/LIMS frontend. Three core screens, four distinct variations each, plus mobile — each annotated as a design review.

PREPARED FOR

NextLaBIS design review · April 2026

SCOPE

Dashboard · Object detail · Navigation sidebar · Mobile key screens

FIDELITY

Mid-fi · b&w · Mantine-accurate sizing · 14px base

NOT COVERED

Search, storage (LIMS), plate viewer, admin, create wizard, command palette — tackle after direction is picked.

CONTENTS

1. Dashboard — 4 variations
2. Object detail — 4 variations
3. Navigation sidebar — 4 variations
4. Mobile — 3 key screens

§ 01

Dashboard

Four divergent approaches to the home screen. Explores the spaces-first vs. activity-first vs. pinned-first layout debate from §8.1.

A
Spaces-first

B
Activity-first

C
Pinned-first

D
Mission control

Good morning, Sarah

4 spaces · 27 projects · last sync 2 min ago

⤴ Import

+ New project

1

Personal greeting + lab-wide counts replace generic "Welcome". Softens the density.

user



Primary research space for condensed-matter and quantum-optics experiments. Shared with 8 lab members.

📁 12 📖 48 📦 1847 👤 S. Johnson ⌚ 2h

QUANT_OPT

User



Quantum Optics Research

Entangled-photon source development and characterization ca

📁 7 📖 23 📦 412 👤 L. Chen ⌚ yesterday

2

"New project" primary (most users can) · "Request Space" gated — was "Create Space" in Figma, which 90% of users can't do.

INST_SHARED

Observer



Shared Instruments

Equipment registry and calibration logs for shared instrumentation.

📁 3 📖 14 📦 89 👤 Lab Manager ⌚ 3d

METHODS_DEV

User



Methods Development

Protocols, SOPs, and assay-development notebooks.

📁 5 📖 17 📦 256 👤 S. Johnson ⌚ 1w

3

Cmd+K in topbar kills the big dashboard search card — reclaim vertical space.



Request new Space

Admin approval required

Recent activity

View all

Across all spaces you can see



INST_042 · Scanning Probe Microscope #3

You updated 3 properties · Quantum Optics

12 min ago



COLL_Q2 · Calibration run — April W16

Dr. Chen created · Physics Laboratory

1 hour ago

Activity

Everything changing across your spaces

- All
- Missing
- Mentions
- Frozen
- Imports

Filter

1 For lab heads who care about "what changed overnight" more than "which space". Feed is primary.

- 🔍

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

You updated 3 properties · Quantum Optics

12 min ago
- 📅

COLL_Q2 · Calibration run — April W16

Dr. Chen created · Physics Laboratory

1 hour ago
- 📄

20260422103344-2213 · 14 files uploaded

Auto-import from dropbox /incoming/spm

2 hours ago
- 📁

PRJ_QD_CHAR · Quantum dot characterization

M. Keller archived

yesterday
- 🏷️

Tag "needs-review" assigned to 7 objects

You

2 days ago
- 🔒

COLL_2025_Q1 frozen (children, datasets)

Lab Manager

3 days ago
- 📦

SMP_2613 · Graphene sample #17

Dr. Chen moved → PRJ_QD_CHAR

4 days ago

2 Surfaces pending async ops (archive, export, import) — addresses \$8.1 gap on where these live.

Pinned

+

SMP_2613

Graphene sample #17

PHYS_LAB / PRJ_QD_CHAR / COLL_APR

COLL_APR

April calibration runs

PHYS_LAB / PRJ_QD_CHAR

INST_042

Scanning probe microscope #3

INST_SHARED / PRJ_INSTRUMENTS

Your spaces

- 🔬

Physics Laboratory

PHYS_LAB

1847
- 🔬

Quantum Optics Research

QUANT_OPT

412
- 🔬

Shared Instruments

INST_SHARED

89
- 🔬

Methods Development

METHODS_DEV

256

Async operations

2 running

RO-Crate export · PRJ_QD_CHAR

62% · ~3 min left

Dashboard

WELCOME BACK

Jump back in

🔍

Paste permId or / identifier path...

1 Pins take the hero slot. Bets that daily work is "open the 4 things I always open".

Object

Graphene sample #17

PHYS_LAB / PRJ_QD_CHAR / COLL_APR

COLL_APR

Collection

April calibration runs

PHYS_LAB / PRJ_QD_CHAR

INST_042

Object

Scanning probe microscope #3

INST_SHARED / PRJ_INSTRUMENTS

PRJ_METHODS

Project

Methods develop

METHODS_DEV

2 Identifier-paste field = resolves \$9 pattern 5. Pastes `'/SPACE/PROJECT/OBJECT'` → navigate.

Recent work

Entities you touched recently

3 Spaces demoted to a list – de-emphasized because most users live inside 1 or 2.

📦 SMP_2613 · Graphene sample #17 You edited properties	12 min
📁 PRJ_QD_CHAR · Quantum dot characterization You opened	2 h
📄 20260422103344 dataset · 14 files You uploaded	yesterday

Your spaces

All 4

🧪 Physics Laboratory PHYS_LAB · 12p · 1847o	Power user
🧪 Quantum Optics Research QUANT_OPT · 7p · 412o	User
🧪 Shared Instruments INST_SHARED · 3p · 89o	Observer
🧪 Methods Development METHODS_DEV · 5p · 256o	User

Today

Scan

+ Create

PINNED

4 YOUR SPACES

4 ACTIVITY

VIEW ALL

1 3 equal columns = no single "primary" – trades hierarchy for density. Risky on small laptops.

Object

COLL_APR

April calibration runs

Object

INST_042

Scanning probe microscope #3

Project

PRJ_METHODS

Methods development

PHYS_LAB

Power user

Physics Laboratory

12 projects · 1847 objects

QUANT_OPT

User

Quantum Optics Research

7 projects · 412 objects

INST_SHARED

Observer

Shared Instruments

3 projects · 89 objects

METHODS_DEV

User

Methods Development

5 projects · 256 objects

INST_042 · Scanning Probe Microscope #3

You updated 3 properties · Quantum Optics · 2 hours ago

COLL_Q2 · Calibration run — April W

Dr. Chen created · Physics Laboratory · 2 hours ago

20260422103344-2213 · 14 files uploaded

Auto-import from dropbox /incoming/spm · 2 hours ago

PRJ_QD_CHAR · Quantum dot characterization

M. Keller archived · yesterday

ASYNC · 2

RO-Crate export · PRJ_QD_CHAR

62% · ~3 min left

Archive · 42 datasets

Queued · 18%

2 QR-scan button promoted to top bar – lab-floor use case for mobile/tablet.

3 Async column makes ops queue always visible – good for lab managers, possibly noisy otherwise.

§ 02

Object detail

Tabs vs. stacked sections vs. split view vs. inspector drawer. Addresses the §8.3 edit-flow question and missing surfaces (datasets, comments, tags).

A

Tabbed

B

Stacked + ToC

C

Split

D

Drawer edit

A · Tabbed (Figma baseline)

A · Tabbed (Figma baseline)

Dashboard

Inventory

Search

Create

Jump to...



Dr. S. Johnson · Physics Lab

SJ

Physics Laboratory > Instruments > Equipment > INST_042

INST_042

Calibrated

Instrument

20240319144821-2842

Edit

+ New child

...

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

Lab-floor SPM used for surface topology on quantum-dot samples. Due for recalibration May 2026.

Dr. S. Johnson Created 2024-03-19 Modified 2 hours ago 3 children 14 datasets

2 Edit toggles inline edit mode – Edit becomes Save/Cancel, banner appears for unsaved changes.

Properties

Files & Datasets 14

Relationships 7

History

Comments 2

1 Tabs keep the page short; you commit to context before seeing content. Good for deep properties, bad for "scan the whole record".

3 Tag row surfaced in properties (\$8.3 gap). Comments tab now a real tab (\$8.3 gap).

INST_042

Object type * ?

Instrument

Identifier

/PHYS_LAB/PRJ_INSTRUMENTS/COLL_EQUIPMENT/INST_042

Perm ID

20240319144821-2842

Parent collection

COLL_EQUIPMENT

Tags

needs-review, spm, shared

Instrument details

Manufacturer, model, and location

Manufacturer ?

Bruker

Model

Dimension Icon

Serial number

DI-2021-0473

Location

Room B-217, bench 4

Responsible

Dr. S. Johnson

Install date

2021-08-14

Calibration

ON THIS PAGE

- Overview
- Basic information
- Instrument details
- History
- Comments (2)

1 ToC replaces tabs.
Everything visible, jump by click.
Wins for printing & "read whole record".

INST_042

● Calibrated

Instrument

20240319144821-2842

🔖

✎ Edit

+ New child

...

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

Lab-floor SPM used for surface topology on quantum-dot samples. Due for recalibration May 2026.

👤 Dr. S. Johnson

📅 Created 2024-03-19

🕒 Modified 2 hours ago

👶 3 children

📁 14 datasets

Basic information

Core identifiers and type

Code * ?	Object type * ?
INST_042	Instrument
Identifier	Perm ID
/PHYS_LAB/PRJ_INSTRUMENTS/COLL_EQUIPMENT/INST_042	20240319144821-2842
Parent collection	Tags
COLL_EQUIPMENT	needs-review, spm, shared

2 Datasets table inline (not a tab) – solves §8.3 where Datasets was buried in "Files & Datasets".

Instrument details

Manufacturer, model, and location

Manufacturer ?	Model
Bruker	Dimension Icon
Serial number	Location
DI-2021-0473	Room B-217, bench 4
Responsible	Install date
Dr. S. Johnson	2021-08-14

C · Split (props + context)

C · Split (props + context)

Dashboard

Inventory

Search

Create

Jump to... %K

Dr. S. Johnson · Physics Lab SJ

Physics Laboratory > Instruments > COLL_EQUIPMENT > INST_042

INST_042 • Calibrated Instrument 20240319144821-2842

Edit + New child

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

Lab-floor SPM used for surface topology on quantum-dot samples. Due for recalibration May 2026.

Dr. S. Johnson Created 2024-03-19 Modified 2 hours ago 3 children 14 datasets

Properties

Files & Datasets 14

History

2 Files/Datasets and History remain tabs – they're list-heavy and benefit from full width.

INST_042

Object type * ?

Instrument

Identifier

/PHYS_LAB/PRJ_INSTRUMENTS/COLL_EQUIPMENT/INST_042

Perm ID

20240319144821-2842

Parent collection

COLL_EQUIPMENT

Tags

needs-review, spm, shared

Instrument details

Manufacturer, model, and location

Manufacturer ?

Bruker

Model

Dimension Icon

Serial number

DI-2021-0473

Location

Room B-217, bench 4

Responsible

Dr. S. Johnson

Install date

2021-08-14

Relationships

Graph

PARENTS · 2

SMP_2613 Graphene sample #17

PRJ_QD_CHAR Quantum dot characterization

CHILDREN · 3

TIP_81 Cantilever tip #81

TIP_82 Cantilever tip #82

CAL_042_APR Apr calibration run

1 Relationships, comments, tags always visible alongside properties. Less tab-whacking; more scan-friendly.

Comments

2 open threads

LC L. Chen · 1h Noise floor looks a bit elevated on ch.3 — rerun?

Tags

+

needs-review spm shared recalibrate

Calibration

Most recent calibration record

D · Read-first, drawer edit

D · Read-first, drawer edit

Dashboard

Inventory

Search

Create

Jump to...



Dr. S. Johnson · Physics Lab

SJ

Physics Laboratory > Instruments > COLL_EQUIPMENT > INST_042

INST_042

Calibrated

Instrument

20240319144821-2842

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

Lab-floor SPM used for surface topology on quantum-dot samples. Due for recalibration May 2026.

Dr. S. Johnson Created 2024-03-19 Modified 2 hours ago 3 children 14

1 Read mode uses label : value, not disabled inputs. Faster to scan, prints cleanly, no fake "field" affordance.

3 Tradeoff: big inline edits of many sections become drawer-hopping. Offer "Edit all" → full page mode.

2 Edit opens a section-scoped drawer — never leaves context. Great for quick touch-ups.

BASIC INFORMATION

Code	INST_042
Object type	Instrument
Parent collection	COLL_EQUIPMENT
Identifier	/PHYS_LAB/PRJ_INSTRUMENTS/COLL_EQUIPMENT/INST_042
Perm ID	20240319144821-2842
Tags	needs-review · spm · shared

Instrument details

Manufacturer	Bruker
Model	Dimension Icon
Serial number	DI-2021-0473
Location	Room B-217, bench 4
Responsible	Dr. S. Johnson
Install date	2021-08-14

Calibration

Last calibrated	2026-03-04 14:22
Next calibration due	2026-05-04 in 12 days

EDIT

Calibration



Last calibrated

2026-03-04 14:22

Next calibration due *

2026-05-04

Due in 12 days

Calibrated by

M. Keller

Method

SOP-CAL-SPM-v3.2

Notes

Tip replaced...

	From Calibration Unit	2023-01-01 to 2023-01-31	
	Calibrated by	M. Keller	
	Method	SOP-CAL-SPM-v3.2	

§ 03

Navigation sidebar

Four takes on the hierarchical tree — extending the Figma frame with filter, rail, columns, and a code-forward variant.

A

Filter + pins

B

Icon rail

C

Column browser

D

Code-forward

Physics Laboratory > PRJ_QD_CHAR > COLL_APR

Filter...

PINNED

- SMP_2613
- COLL_APR

SPACES

- Physics Laboratory
 - Quantum dot char.
 - April calibration
 - March calibration
 - Baseline runs
 - Instruments
 - Methods
- Quantum Optics
- Shared Instruments
- Methods Development

1 Filter added at top (\$8.6 gap)
— fuzzy-matches names, codes, tags.

2 Pinned section — persists across sessions.

3 External-link icon appears on hover/active only (Figma had a redundant "View X" text row).

B · Icon rail (collapsed)

Physics Laboratory > PRJ_QD_CHAR > COLL_APR

>

PHYSICS LABORATORY

Flyout (hover)

▾

Quantum dot char.

▸

April calibration

☰

March calibration

☰

Baseline runs

☐

Instruments

☐

Methods

🌟

🌟

🧪

🧪

🧪

🧪

⚙️

1

Rail mode reclaims width for content. Click chevron or hover to expand to full tree.

2

Active node gets a vertical accent bar (\$11 a11y: not color-only — icon is always visible too).

Physics Laboratory > PRJ_QD_CHAR > COLL_APR

SPACES	PROJECTS · PHYS_LAB	COLLECTIONS · PRJ_QD_CHAR
PHYS_LAB Physics Laboratory	PRJ_QD_CHAR Quantum dot char.	COLL_APR April calibration
QUANT_OPT Quantum Optics	PRJ_INSTRUMENTS Instruments	COLL_MAR March calibration
INST_SHARED Shared Instruments	PRJ_METHODS Methods	COLL_BASE Baseline runs
METHODS_DEV Methods Development		

1

Columns replace tree. One level per column — always shows depth, no expand/collapse mental model.

2

Scales poorly past 4 levels on laptop widths. Best for 2-3 level

D · Code-forward

D · Code-forward (power user)

- Dashboard
- Inventory
- Search
- Create

Physics Laboratory > PRJ_QD_CHAR > COLL_APR

🔍 Paste identifier or code...

- ▼ 🔧 PHYS_LAB
- ▼ 📁 PRJ_QD_CHAR
- ▶ 📁 COLL_APR
- 📁 COLL_MAR
- 📁 COLL_BASE
- 📁 PRJ_INSTRUMENTS
- 📁 PRJ_METHODS
- 🔧 QUANT_OPT
- 🔧 INST_SHARED
- 🔧 METHODS_DEV

- 🔗 Open in new tab
- 🔗 Rename
- ➔ Move...
- 🔒 Freeze...
- 📄 Copy identifier

1 Identifier codes primary, titles secondary. For users who paste/type permIds daily.

2 Full identifier path visible on hover – supports copy-to-clipboard (§? pattern 6).

§ 04

Mobile

Dashboard, object detail, QR scan. Scan is the hero lab-floor action; Cmd+K isn't reachable on phone.

01

Dashboard

02

Object detail

03

QR scan

—

Desktop-only screens get
"open on larger screen"
fallbacks

Dashboard

Tuesday, Apr 22

Hi, Sarah

 Search or paste identifier...

 Scan QR on instrument

PINNED

SMP_2613

Object

Graphene sample #17

INST_042

Instrument

SPM #3

COLL_APR

Collection

April calibration

RECENT ACTIVITY



INST_042 updated

You · 12 min



COLL_APR created

L. Chen · 1h

Object
detail

Read-first · single-column label : value
rows

INST_042 • Calibrated

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

Room B-217, bench 4

 Edit

+ Add dataset

- Properties
- Files
14
- Links
7
- History

BASIC INFORMATION

Code	INST_042
Type	Instrument
Location	Room B-217

INSTRUMENT

Manufacturer	Bruker
Model	Dimension Icon
Serial	DI-2021-0473

CALIBRATION

Last	2026-03-04
Next due	2026-05-04 ⚠

QR scan

Point camera at the sticker on an instrument, rack, or box

Enter code manually



DETECTED

INST_042

• Calibrated

Scanning Probe Microscope #3

/PHYS_LAB/PRJ_INSTRUMENTS/COLL_EQUIPMENT/INST_042

Cancel

Open record →



Home



Search



Scan



Pins



You